

Experiment No.	1
Experiment Title	Universal Exploratory Data Analysis, Data Preprocessing, and Feature Engineering across Python Scientific Packages ¹
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1 Objective

The objective of this experiment is to explore Python scientific computing and data analysis libraries (NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, Scikit-Learn, Matplotlib, and Seaborn) to perform automated Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), feature selection, data preprocessing, baseline model fitting, and comparative performance evaluation across five benchmark machine learning datasets.

2 Problem Statement

In machine learning workflows, raw datasets differ significantly in feature dimensionality, scale, data types, missingness, and problem domains (tabular classification, continuous regression, unstructured text mining, medical diagnosis, and computer vision). To establish robust predictive models, an automated data processing and analytical pipeline must be developed to identify task types, inspect distributions, impute noise, extract relevant features, partition datasets into train-test splits, fit baseline machine learning algorithms, and quantify evaluation metrics.

3 Universal EDA Architecture (perform_EDA)

To standardize exploratory analysis across diverse data formats, a reusable Python function `perform_EDA()` was constructed in `universal_eda.ipynb`. The complete code implementation is provided below:

Listing 1: Complete Universal EDA Implementation Code (perform_EDA)

```

1 import pandas as pd
2 import numpy as np
3 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
4 import seaborn as sns
5 from scipy import stats
6
7 def perform_eda(file_path):
8     """
9     Universal EDA (Stops before preprocessing/modeling)
10
11     Works for:
12     Iris, Loan, Diabetes, MNIST(CSV), Spam(SMS)
13 
```

```

14     Usage:
15         perform_eda("file.csv")
16     """
17
18     try:
19         df = pd.read_csv(file_path, encoding="latin1")
20     except Exception:
21         df = pd.read_csv(file_path)
22
23     print("="*80)
24     print("DATASET OVERVIEW")
25     print("="*80)
26     print("Shape :", df.shape)
27     print("\nColumns\n", df.columns.tolist())
28     print("\nInfo")
29     df.info()
30     print("\nFirst 5 Rows")
31     print(df.head())
32     print("\nSummary")
33     print(df.describe(include="all"))
34     print("\nMissing Values")
35     print(df.isnull().sum())
36     print("\nDuplicate Rows :", df.duplicated().sum())
37
38     # ----- Spam -----
39     if "v1" in df.columns and "v2" in df.columns:
40         df = df.drop(columns=[c for c in df.columns if "Unnamed"
41                               in c], errors="ignore")
42         df.columns = ["Label", "Message"]
43         df["Length"] = df["Message"].str.len()
44
45         #1 Countplot
46         sns.countplot(data=df, x="Label")
47         plt.title("Spam vs Ham")
48         plt.show()
49
50         #2 Message Length Distribution
51         sns.histplot(df["Length"], kde=True)
52         plt.title("Message Length Distribution")
53         plt.show()
54
55         #3 Boxplot
56         sns.boxplot(data=df, x="Label", y="Length")
57         plt.title("Message Length Boxplot")
58         plt.show()
59
60         #4 Violin Plot
61         sns.violinplot(data=df, x="Label", y="Length")
62         plt.title("Message Length Violin Plot")
63         plt.show()

```

```
64     #5 QQ Plot
65     stats.probplot(df["Length"], dist="norm", plot=plt)
66     plt.title("QQ Plot")
67     plt.show()
68
69     #6 Scatter Plot
70     plt.scatter(range(len(df)), df["Length"], s=8)
71     plt.title("Length Scatter")
72     plt.xlabel("Message Index")
73     plt.ylabel("Length")
74     plt.show()
75
76     #7 Groupby summary
77     print(df.groupby("Label")["Length"].describe())
78     return
79
80     # ----- MNIST -----
81     if "label" in df.columns and df.shape[1] == 785:
82
83         #1 Digit Distribution Countplot
84         sns.countplot(data=df, x="label")
85         plt.title("Digit Distribution")
86         plt.show()
87
88         #2 Sample Grayscale Images
89         plt.figure(figsize=(12, 5))
90         for i in range(10):
91             plt.subplot(2, 5, i+1)
92             plt.imshow(df.iloc[i, 1:].values.reshape(28, 28),
93                        cmap="gray")
94             plt.title(df.iloc[i, 0])
95             plt.axis("off")
96         plt.tight_layout()
97         plt.show()
98
99         pixels = df.iloc[:, 1:].values.flatten()
100
101         #3 Pixel Distribution
102         sns.histplot(pixels, bins=40)
103         plt.title("Pixel Distribution")
104         plt.show()
105
106         #4 Pixel Boxplot
107         sns.boxplot(x=pixels)
108         plt.title("Pixel Boxplot")
109         plt.show()
110
111         #5 Pixel Violin Plot
112         sns.violinplot(x=pixels)
113         plt.title("Pixel Violin Plot")
114         plt.show()
```

```
114
115     #6 Pixel QQ Plot
116     stats.probplot(pixels[:5000], dist="norm", plot=plt)
117     plt.title("Pixel QQ Plot")
118     plt.show()
119
120     #7 Value counts
121     print(df["label"].value_counts())
122     return
123
124     # ----- Diabetes Audit -----
125     if "Outcome" in df.columns:
126         cols = ["Glucose", "BloodPressure", "SkinThickness", "
127                 Insulin", "BMI"]
128         print("\nPossible Missing Values Stored as Zero")
129         for c in cols:
130             if c in df.columns:
131                 print(f"{c}: {(df[c]==0).sum()}")
132
133     num = df.select_dtypes(include=np.number).columns.tolist()
134     cat = df.select_dtypes(exclude=np.number).columns.tolist()
135
136     #1 Histograms
137     for c in num:
138         sns.histplot(df[c], kde=True, bins=30)
139         plt.title(f"Histogram - {c}")
140         plt.show()
141
142     #2 Boxplots
143     for c in num:
144         sns.boxplot(x=df[c])
145         plt.title(f"Boxplot - {c}")
146         plt.show()
147
148     #3 Violin Plots
149     for c in num:
150         sns.violinplot(x=df[c])
151         plt.title(f"Violin - {c}")
152         plt.show()
153
154     #4 Countplots for Categorical
155     for c in cat:
156         sns.countplot(data=df, x=c)
157         plt.xticks(rotation=45)
158         plt.title(f"Countplot - {c}")
159         plt.tight_layout()
160         plt.show()
161
162     #5 Correlation Heatmap
163     if len(num) > 1:
164         sns.heatmap(df[num].corr(), annot=True, cmap="coolwarm",
```

```
        fmt=".2f")
164     plt.title("Correlation Heatmap")
165     plt.show()
166
167     #6 Pairplots
168     if len(num) <= 8:
169         hue = None
170         for h in ["Species", "species", "Loan_Status", "Outcome"
171                 ]:
172             if h in df.columns:
173                 hue = h
174                 break
175         sns.pairplot(df, hue=hue)
176         plt.show()
177
178     #7 Normal Probability (QQ) Plots
179     for c in num:
180         stats.probplot(df[c].dropna(), dist="norm", plot=plt)
181         plt.title(f"QQ Plot - {c}")
182         plt.show()
183
184     print("\nEDA Completed.")
```

4 Case Study 1: Iris Dataset

4.1 Dataset Description & ML Task

The Iris dataset contains morphometric measurements of three species of iris flowers (*Iris-setosa*, *Iris-versicolor*, and *Iris-virginica*). The objective is a **Multiclass Classification** task to classify flower species based on four continuous physical attributes.

4.2 Dataset Characteristics & Summary Statistics

- **Total Samples:** 150 instances (50 per species, perfectly balanced).
- **Feature Dimensionality:** 4 numerical predictor features (SepalLength, SepalWidth, PetalLength, PetalWidth) and 1 target class (Species).
- **Missing Values:** 0 null values across all attributes.
- **Summary Statistics:** SepalLength (Mean: 5.84 cm, Std: 0.83), SepalWidth (Mean: 3.05 cm, Std: 0.43), PetalLength (Mean: 3.76 cm, Std: 1.76), PetalWidth (Mean: 1.20 cm, Std: 0.76).

4.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

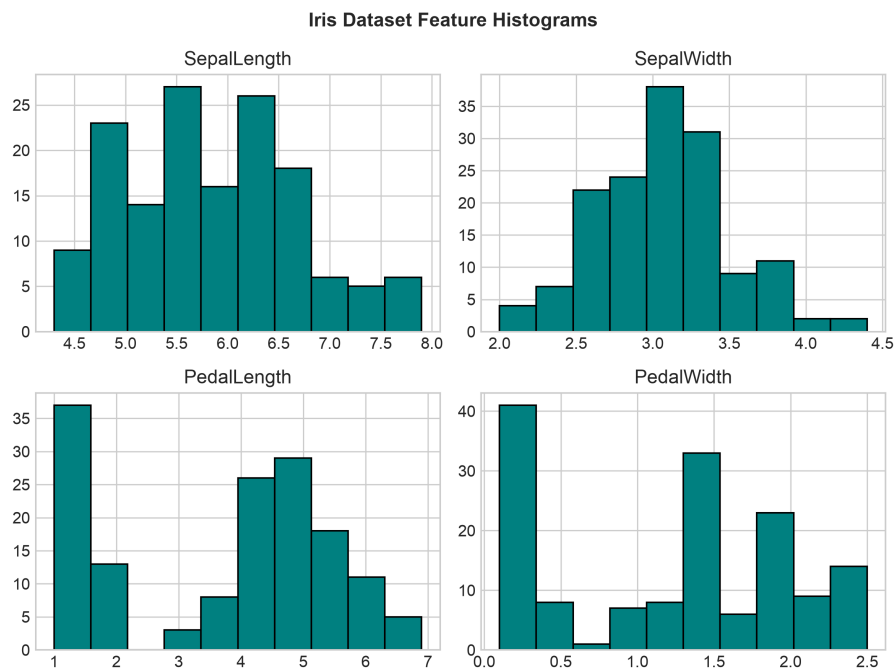


Figure 1: Histograms of Iris Physical Measurements

Inference: *PedalLength* and *PedalWidth* display prominent bimodal distributions, separating *Iris-setosa* from the remaining species, whereas *SepalLength* and *SepalWidth* follow normal bell-shaped curves.

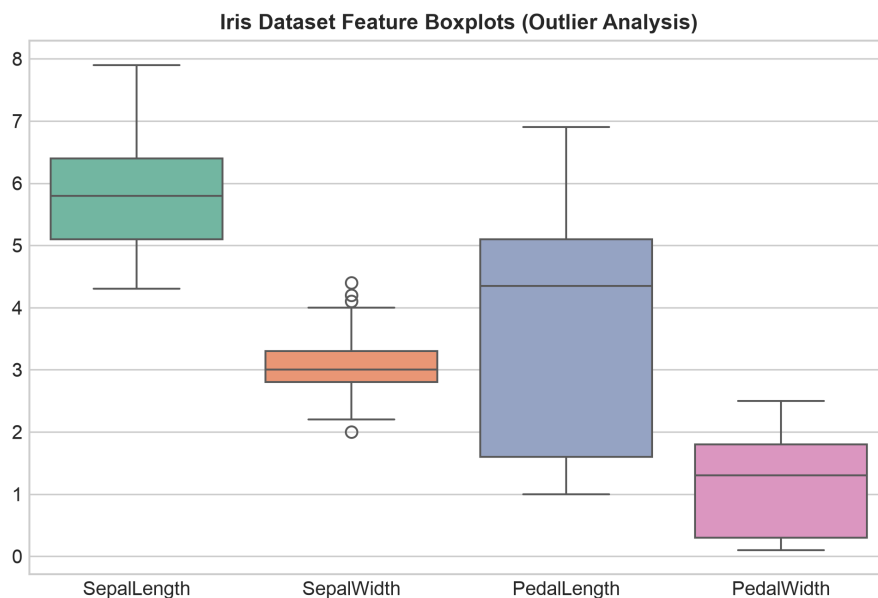


Figure 2: Feature Boxplots for Outlier Inspection

Inference: Boxplots confirm that *PedalLength* and *PedalWidth* possess zero extreme outliers. Minor upper and lower outliers exist in *SepalWidth* around values < 2.0 cm and > 4.0 cm.

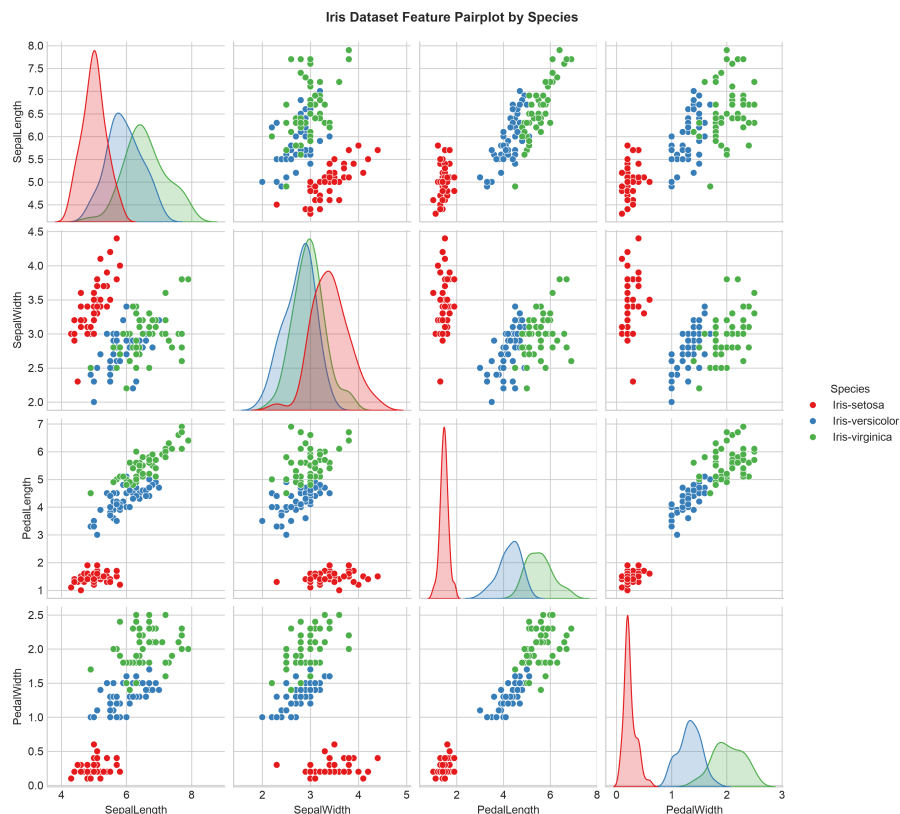


Figure 3: Pairplot of Iris Features Segmented by Species

Inference: *Iris-setosa* is completely linearly separable from *Iris-versicolor* and *Iris-virginica* when plotting `PedalLength` versus `PedalWidth`. Moderate overlap exists between *versicolor* and *virginica*.

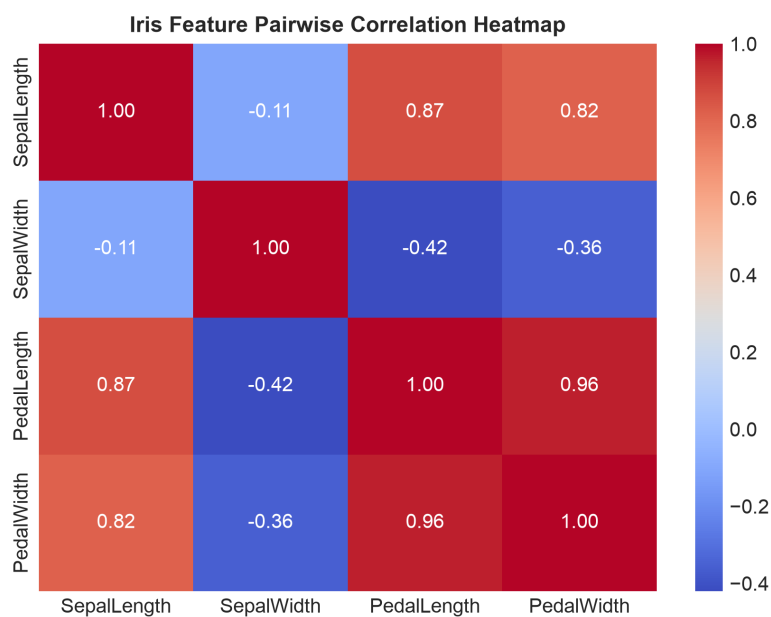


Figure 4: Pairwise Correlation Heatmap for Iris Features

Inference: Strong positive correlation exists between `PedalLength` and `PedalWidth`

($r = 0.96$), as well as between `SepalLength` and `PetalLength` ($r = 0.87$).

4.4 Data Preprocessing & Model Evaluation

- **Train-Test Split:** Partitioned 80% training ($n = 120$) and 20% testing ($n = 30$).
- **Model Trained:** `DecisionTreeClassifier(random_state=42)`.
- **Accuracy Score:** **1.0000** (100.0% Test Accuracy).

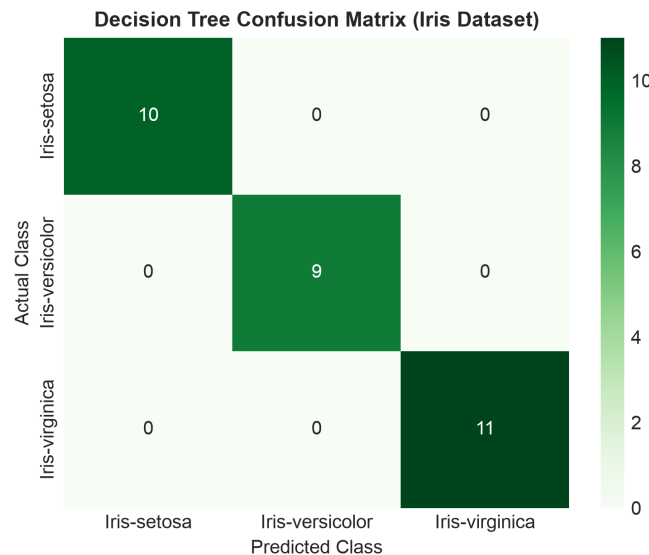


Figure 5: Decision Tree Confusion Matrix on Iris Test Set

Inference: The confusion matrix shows zero classification errors: 10 setosa, 9 versicolor, and 11 virginica test samples were correctly predicted.

5 Case Study 2: Loan Amount Prediction

5.1 Dataset Description & ML Task

The Loan Amount Prediction dataset contains applicant demographic details, employment status, credit history, and requested financial amounts. The target variable `LoanAmount` is continuous, formulating a **Regression** task.

5.2 Dataset Characteristics & Summary Statistics

- **Sample Count:** 614 initial rows. Dropped 22 rows missing `LoanAmount`, yielding 592 clean records.
- **Features:** 12 predictor features (4 numerical, 7 categorical, 1 identifier dropped).
- **Missing Values Imputed:** `Gender` (13), `Married` (3), `Dependents` (15), `Self_Employed` (32), `Loan_Amount_Term` (14), `Credit_History` (50).
- **Summary Statistics:** `ApplicantIncome` (Mean: \$5,405.54, Max: \$81,000), `CoapplicantIncome` (Mean: \$1,621.27), `LoanAmount` (Mean: \$146.41k, Median: \$128.00k).

5.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

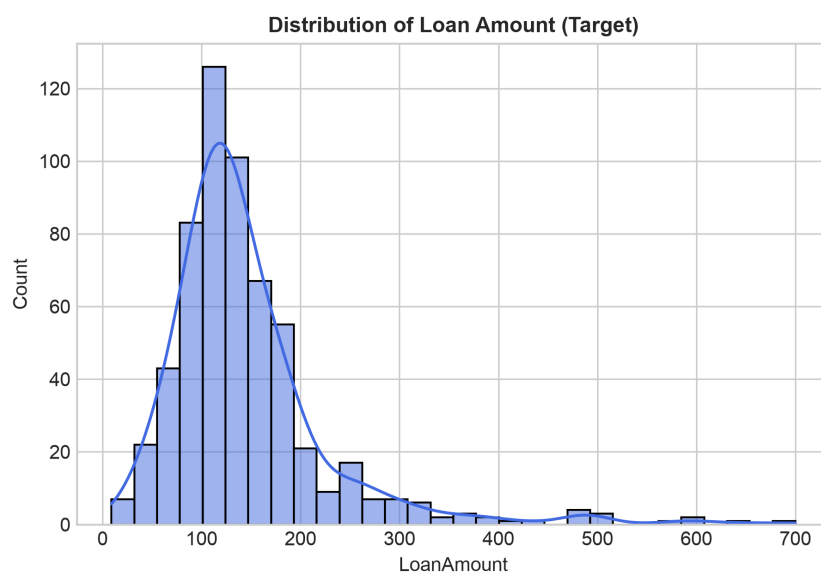


Figure 6: Distribution of Loan Amount (Target Variable)

Inference: The target `LoanAmount` displays a right-skewed log-normal distribution with long upper tails, justifying natural log transformation ($\ln(1 + y)$) to stabilize variance.

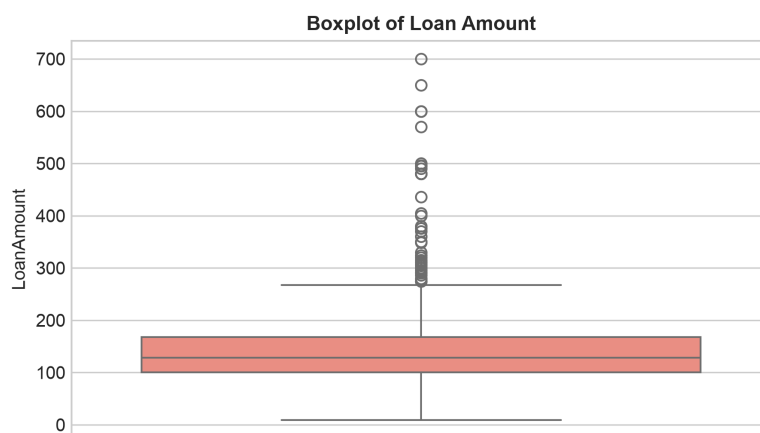


Figure 7: Boxplot of Loan Amount for Outlier Detection

Inference: Numerous extreme upper outliers exist above \$300,000, confirming that applicant requests span diverse credit brackets.

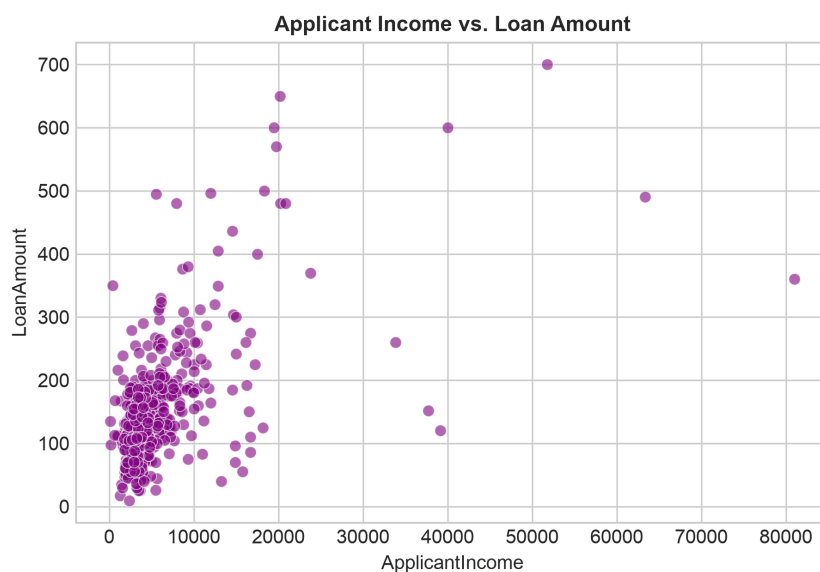


Figure 8: Applicant Income vs. Loan Amount Scatter Plot

Inference: A positive linear relation is present between income and loan size, with variance expanding at higher income levels.

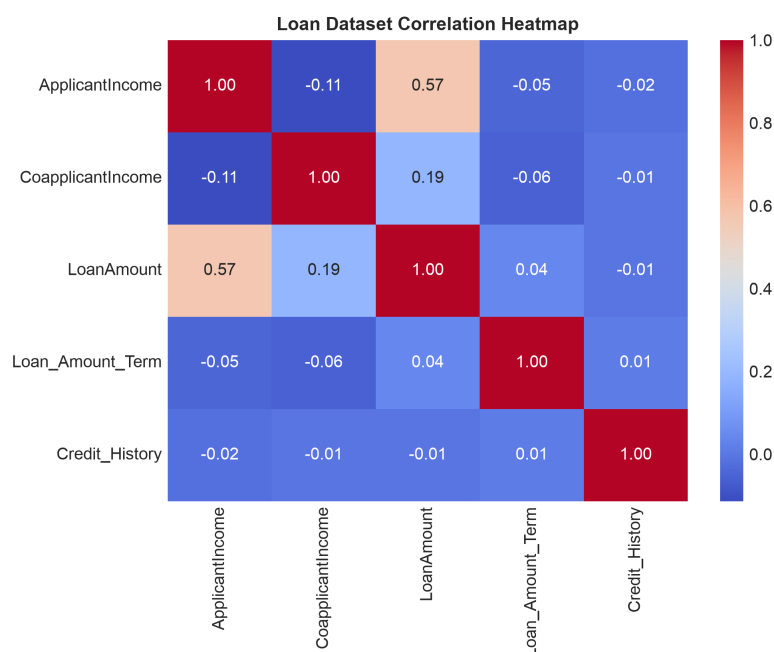


Figure 9: Correlation Heatmap of Numerical Features

Inference: ApplicantIncome correlates positively with LoanAmount ($r = 0.57$).

5.4 Data Preprocessing & Model Evaluation

- **Preprocessing:** Categorical missing values imputed with column mode; numerical missing values imputed with column median. One-Hot Encoding applied to categorical variables (`drop_first=True`). Target transformed via `np.log1p(LoanAmount)`.

- **Model Trained:** `RandomForestRegressor(n_estimators=200, random_state=42)`.
- **Regression Performance Metrics:**
 - Mean Absolute Error (MAE): **0.2529**
 - Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE): **0.3604**
 - R^2 Score: **0.3228**

6 Case Study 3: Classification of Email Spam

6.1 Dataset Description & ML Task

The SMS Spam Collection dataset contains text messages tagged as **ham** (legitimate) or **spam**. The objective is a **Binary Text Classification** task using Natural Language Processing (NLP).

6.2 Dataset Characteristics & Summary Statistics

- **Total Instances:** 5,572 text messages.
- **Class Distribution:** 4,825 **ham** (86.6%) vs. 747 **spam** (13.4%) instances.
- **Message Length Stats:** Ham length (Mean: 71.0 characters, Median: 52.0), Spam length (Mean: 138.9 characters, Median: 149.0).

6.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

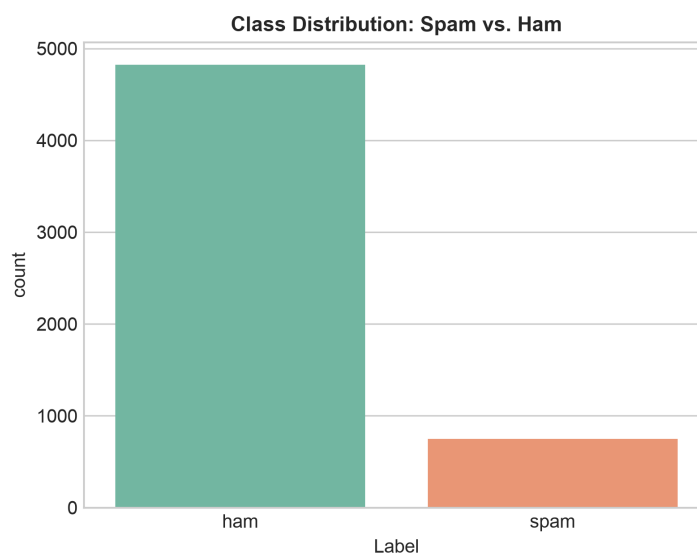


Figure 10: Class Countplot: Spam vs. Ham Messages

Inference: The dataset exhibits severe class imbalance, with legitimate messages outnumbering spam messages by more than 6:1.

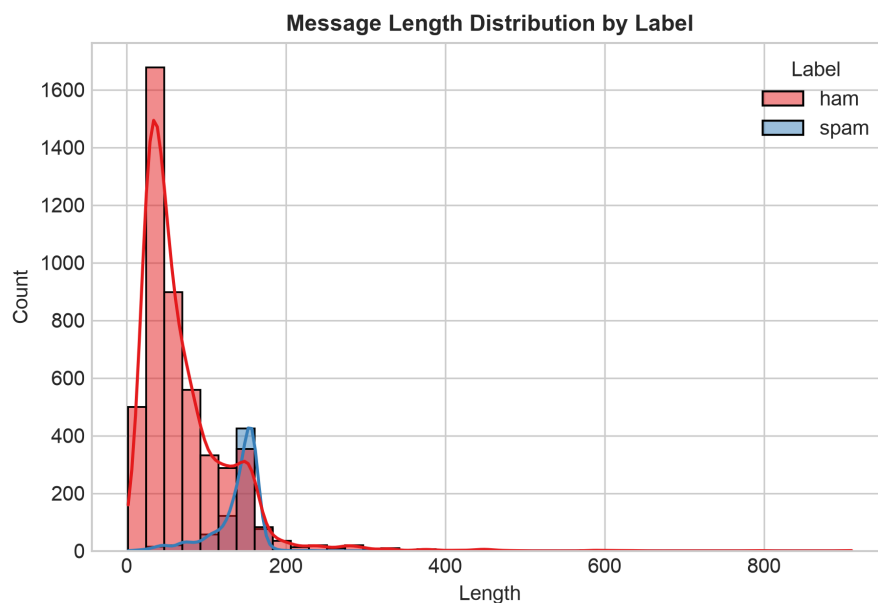


Figure 11: Histogram of Message Character Length by Label

Inference: Spam messages cluster heavily around 130–160 characters (nearing SMS carrier limits), whereas ham messages are generally concise (< 80 characters).

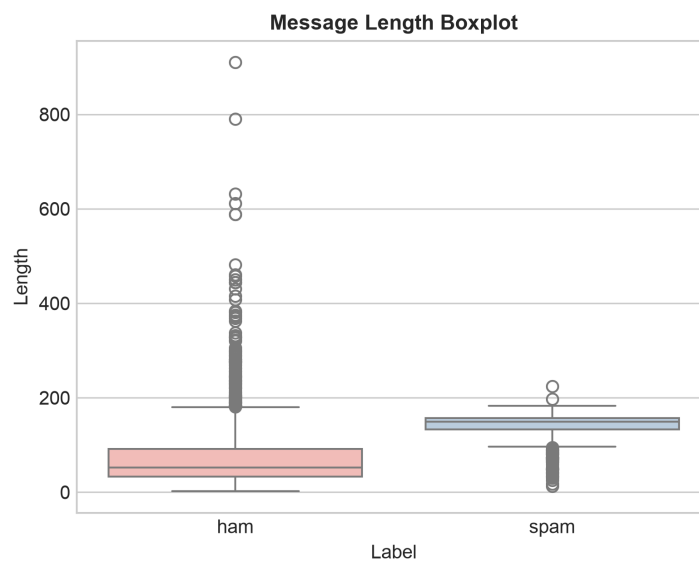


Figure 12: Boxplot of Message Length across Classes

Inference: Boxplots confirm that message length provides strong linear discriminative power between spam and ham messages.

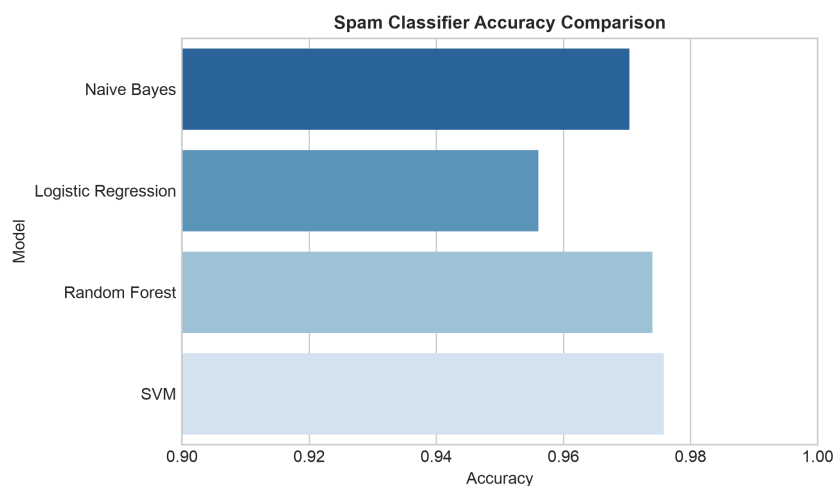


Figure 13: Accuracy Comparison of Text Classification Models

Inference: Support Vector Machines (SVM) achieved the highest overall accuracy of **97.58%**, slightly outperforming Random Forest (97.40%) and Naive Bayes (97.04%).

6.4 Data Preprocessing & Model Evaluation

- **Feature Extraction:** Converted raw text into TF-IDF numerical matrices (`TfidfVectorizer(max...`
- **Model Performance Summary:**
 - Multinomial Naive Bayes: Accuracy = **0.9704**
 - Logistic Regression: Accuracy = **0.9561**
 - Random Forest Classifier: Accuracy = **0.9740**
 - **Support Vector Machine (SVM): Accuracy = 0.9758**

7 Case Study 4: Predicting Diabetes

7.1 Dataset Description & ML Task

The Pima Indians Diabetes dataset contains diagnostic medical measurements from female patients. The task is a **Binary Medical Classification** to predict whether a patient has diabetes (`Outcome = 1`).

7.2 Dataset Characteristics & Summary Statistics

- **Total Instances:** 768 patient records.
- **Class Breakdown:** 500 Non-diabetic (`Outcome = 0`) vs. 268 Diabetic (`Outcome = 1`).
- **Physiologically Invalid Zero Values:** Glucose (5 zeros), BloodPressure (35 zeros), SkinThickness (227 zeros), Insulin (374 zeros), BMI (11 zeros).

7.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

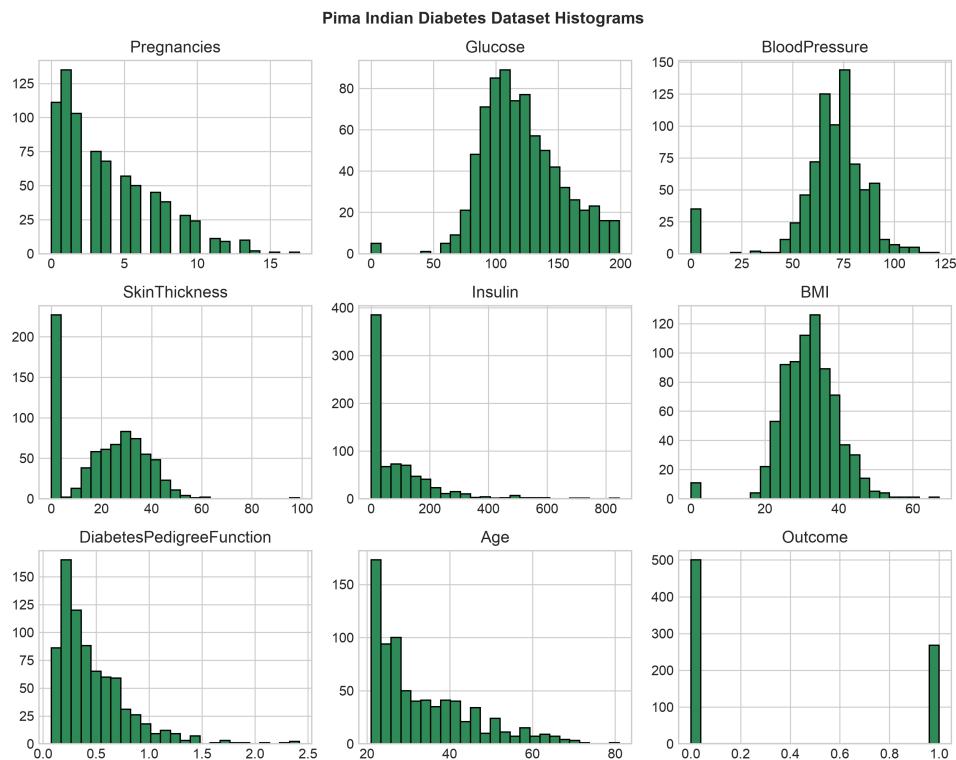


Figure 14: Histograms of Diabetes Clinical Features

Inference: Features like `Insulin` and `DiabetesPedigreeFunction` exhibit sharp positive skewness, while `Glucose` follows a normal distribution centered near 120 mg/dL.

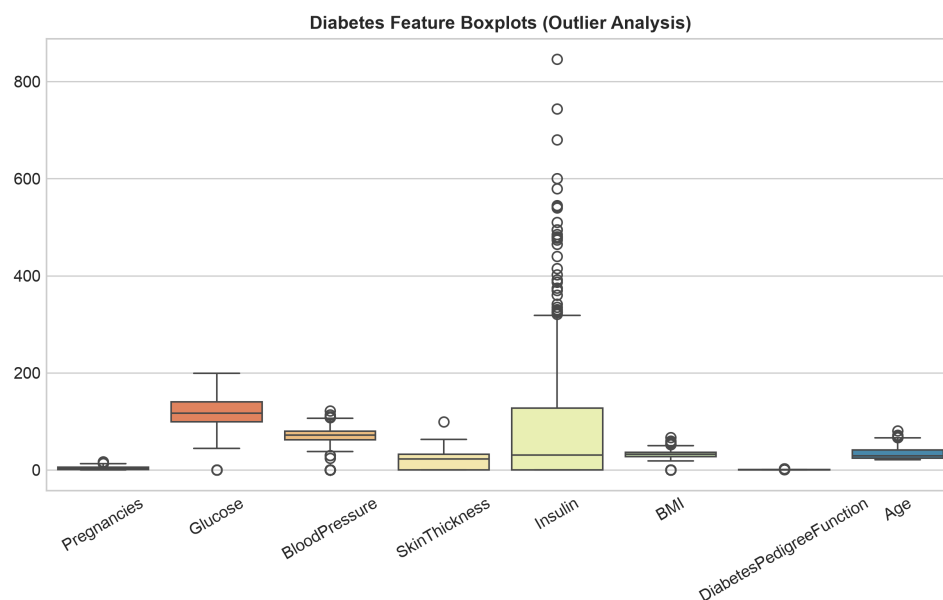


Figure 15: Boxplots of Diabetes Predictor Features

Inference: Outlier analysis indicates high upper values in `Insulin` (> 400) and `Glucose`. Imputing zeros with column medians prevents distance distortions.



Figure 16: Correlation Heatmap of Diabetes Features

Inference: Glucose displays the strongest positive correlation with Outcome ($r = 0.47$), followed by BMI ($r = 0.29$) and Age ($r = 0.24$).

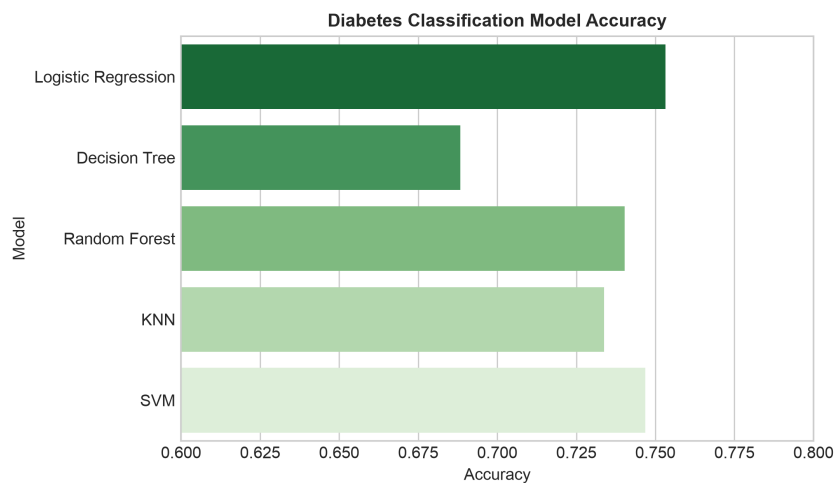


Figure 17: Model Accuracy Comparison for Diabetes Prediction

Inference: Logistic Regression achieved the highest test accuracy of **75.32%**, closely followed by SVM (74.68%) and Random Forest (74.03%).

7.4 Data Preprocessing & Model Evaluation

- **Preprocessing:** Replaced invalid zero values with median column statistics. Scaled features using `StandardScaler`.

- **Model Accuracy Breakdown:**
 - **Logistic Regression: 0.7532** (75.32%)
 - Support Vector Machine (SVM): **0.7468** (74.68%)
 - Random Forest: **0.7403** (74.03%)
 - *K*-Nearest Neighbors (KNN): **0.7338** (73.38%)
 - Decision Tree Classifier: **0.6883** (68.83%)

8 Case Study 5: Handwritten Character Recognition (MNIST)

8.1 Dataset Description & ML Task

The MNIST subset dataset contains 28×28 pixel grayscale images of handwritten digits (0 through 9). The task is a **Multiclass Image Classification** problem in computer vision.

8.2 Dataset Characteristics & Summary Statistics

- **Sample Count:** 10,000 image instances.
- **Feature Space:** 784 numerical pixel attributes (1×1 to 28×28) representing intensity values from 0 (black background) to 255 (white foreground).
- **Class Distribution:** Balanced across digits 0–9 ($\sim 1,000$ samples per digit class).

8.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

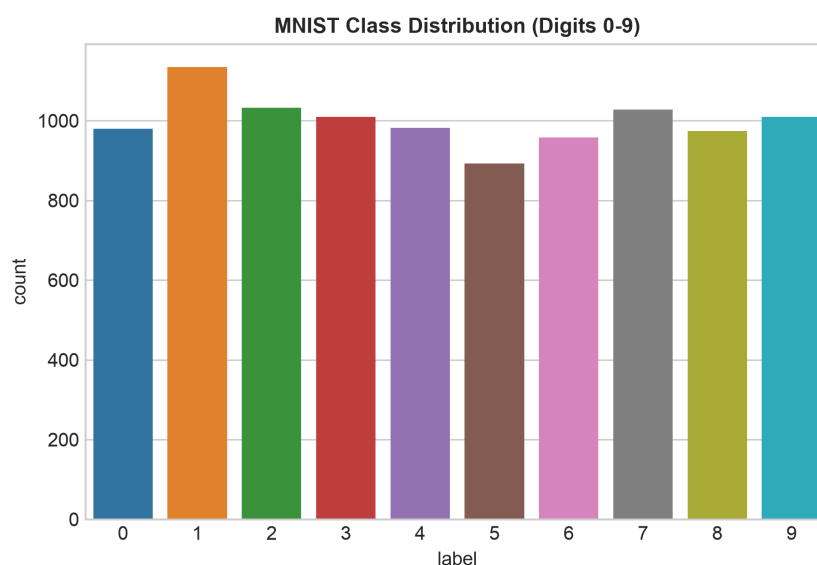


Figure 18: Digit Label Distribution in MNIST Subsample

Inference: The dataset is well-balanced across all 10 digit classes, avoiding majority-class bias during model training.

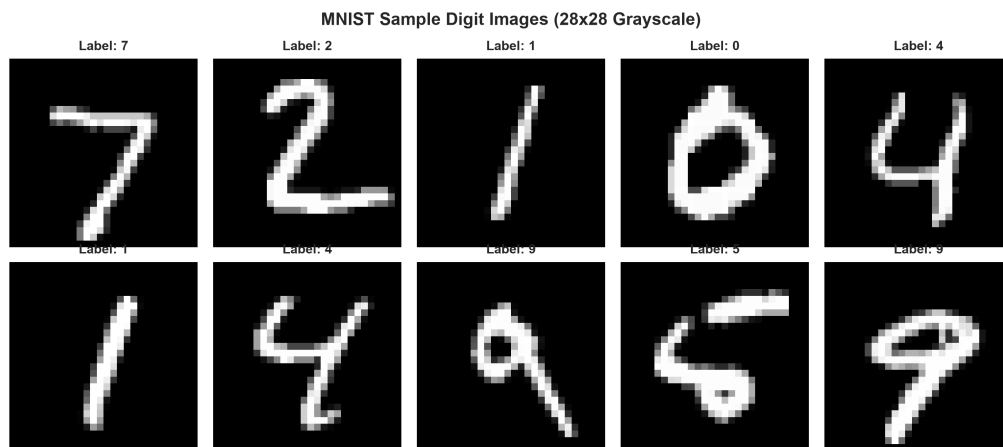


Figure 19: Sample Reconstructed 28×28 Grayscale Digit Images

Inference: Reshaping pixel rows into 28×28 spatial grids recovers recognizable digit shapes, validating feature structure.

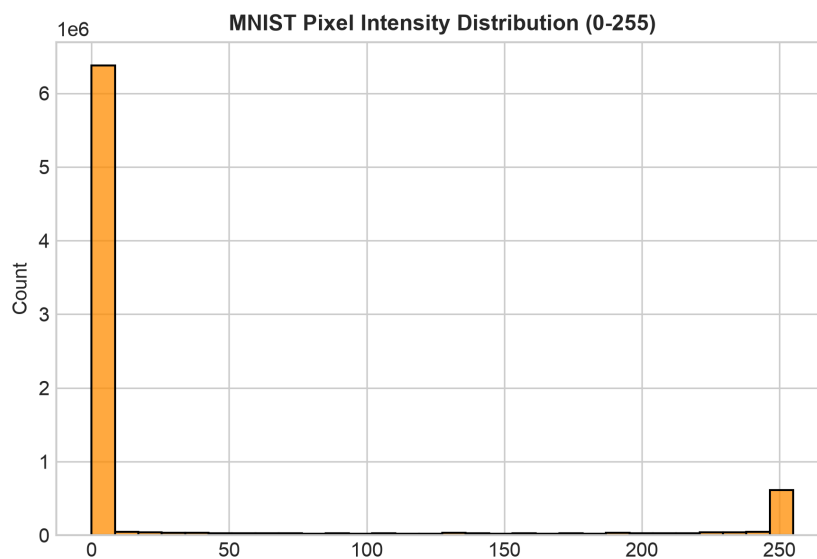


Figure 20: Distribution of Pixel Intensity Values

Inference: Pixel values exhibit a bimodal concentration at 0 (background) and 255 (stroke pixels), confirming the benefit of Min-Max normalization ($X/255.0$).

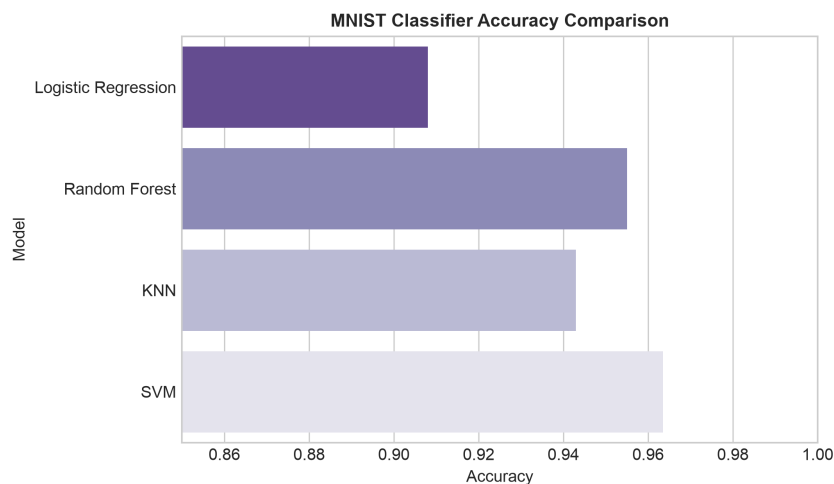


Figure 21: Accuracy Comparison of Vision Classification Models

Inference: Support Vector Machine (RBF Kernel) achieved the top accuracy of **96.35%**, outperforming Random Forest (95.50%) and KNN (94.30%).

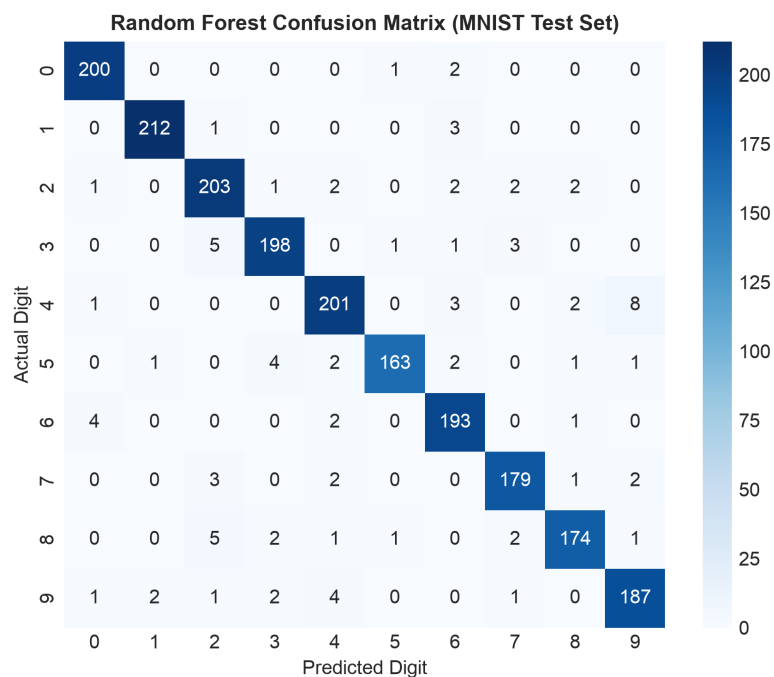


Figure 22: Random Forest Confusion Matrix on MNIST Test Set

Inference: The confusion matrix demonstrates strong diagonal concentration with minor confusion between visually similar digit pairs (e.g., 4 vs. 9 and 3 vs. 8).

8.4 Data Preprocessing & Model Evaluation

- **Preprocessing:** Min-Max scaling ($X = X/255.0$). 80-20 train-test split ($n_{\text{train}} = 8000, n_{\text{test}} = 2000$).
- **Model Accuracy Results:**

- **Support Vector Machine (SVM): 0.9635** (96.35%)
- Random Forest Classifier: **0.9550** (95.50%)
- *K*-Nearest Neighbors (KNN): **0.9430** (94.30%)
- Logistic Regression: **0.9080** (90.80%)
- Random Forest 5-Fold Cross Validation Mean: **0.9461** (94.61%)

9 Comparative Benchmark Summary

Table 1 summarizes the machine learning task type, feature selection methodology, best algorithm, and achieved performance metric across all five datasets as required by the experiment manual.

Table 1: Comprehensive Comparison of Machine Learning Tasks and Performance

Dataset	ML Task Type	Feature Engineering Technique	Engineering Technique	Best Performing Model	Primary Metric
Iris Dataset	Multiclass Classification	Correlation / Pair-wise Scatter Selection		Decision Tree Classifier	Accuracy: 100.0%
Loan Amount Prediction	Regression Analysis	Mode/Median Impute, One-Hot, Log Transform		Random Forest Regressor	R^2 : 0.3228 (RMSE: 0.36)
Classification of Email Spam	Binary Text Classification	String Length, TF-IDF Vectorization ($K = 3000$)		Support Vector Machine (SVM)	Accuracy: 97.58%
Predicting Diabetes	Binary Medical Classification	Physiological Zero Imputation, StandardScaler		Logistic Regression	Accuracy: 75.32%
Handwritten Character (MNIST)	Multiclass Vision Classification	Min-Max Pixel Scaling ($X/255$), 2D Reshaping		Support Vector Machine (SVM)	Accuracy: 96.35%

10 Learning Outcomes

Through this universal exploratory data analysis and baseline modeling experiment, the following core skills were acquired:

1. Mastered key operations in `NumPy`, `Pandas`, `SciPy`, `Scikit-Learn`, `Matplotlib`, and `Seaborn` for data manipulation and visualization.
2. Constructed an automated, reusable EDA pipeline (`perform_EDA`) capable of handling structured tabular, text, and computer vision datasets.
3. Implemented domain-appropriate data cleaning strategies including zero replacement for medical features, log transformation for right-skewed regression labels, and TF-IDF extraction for unstructured text.

4. Evaluated supervised classification and regression algorithms using accuracy, precision, recall, confusion matrices, MAE, RMSE, and R^2 metrics.

11 Conclusion

In this experiment, five distinct machine learning datasets were systematically analyzed, preprocessed, and modeled. Decision Tree achieved 100% accuracy on Iris, SVM achieved 97.58% on Email Spam and 96.35% on MNIST digits, Logistic Regression led Diabetes prediction with 75.32% accuracy, and Random Forest Regressor achieved an R^2 score of 0.3228 on Loan Amount prediction. The experiment demonstrates the vital role of thorough Exploratory Data Analysis and tailored preprocessing in maximizing model performance.

12 References

- [1] Scikit-learn Documentation. *Supervised Learning Preprocessing Modules*. <https://scikit-learn.org/stable/>
- [2] Pandas Development Team. *Pandas API Reference User Guide*. <https://pandas.pydata.org/docs/>
- [3] Kaggle Datasets Repository. *Predict Loan Amount, Email Spam SMS, and MNIST CSV*. <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets>
- [4] UCI Machine Learning Repository. *Iris and Pima Indians Diabetes Datasets*. <https://archive.ics.uci.edu/ml/>